Safeguarding Adults at Risk Policy

Policy Title: Safeguarding Adults at Risk

Effective Date:

Review Date:

Version: 1.0

Applies to: All staff, volunteers, contractors at [INSERT CARE HOME NAME]

1. Policy Statement

[INSERT CARE HOME NAME] is committed to promoting the wellbeing, safety, and rights of adults at risk of abuse or neglect. We have a zero-tolerance approach to all forms of abuse and are fully compliant with the Care Act 2014, CQC Fundamental Standards, and local safeguarding procedures.

Safeguarding is everyone's responsibility. All staff must be able to recognise signs of abuse and take appropriate action to protect those in our care.

2. Purpose

This policy outlines how [INSERT CARE HOME NAME] will:

- Identify and respond to safeguarding concerns
- Prevent abuse through safe practices and culture
- Support individuals who have experienced or are at risk of harm
- Work with local safeguarding partners (e.g. local authority, CQC)

3. Definitions

Adult at Risk:

A person aged 18 or over who:

- Has care and support needs
- Is experiencing or is at risk of abuse or neglect
- Is unable to protect themselves because of those needs

Types of Abuse (as per Care Act 2014):

- Physical
- Sexual
- Psychological/Emotional
- Financial/Material
- Neglect and Acts of Omission

- Organisational (Institutional)
- Discriminatory
- Domestic Abuse
- Modern Slavery
- Self-Neglect

4. Responsibilities

Registered Manager:

- Acts as the Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL)
- Ensures staff training and policy compliance
- Liaises with safeguarding partners and CQC

All Staff:

- Complete safeguarding training at induction and annually
- Report concerns promptly to the DSL
- Treat all allegations seriously and confidentially

5. Procedures

Recognising Abuse:

Staff should be alert to:

- Unexplained injuries or bruises
- Sudden changes in behaviour or mood
- Poor hygiene or nutrition
- Fearful interactions with carers or others
- Unusual financial activity

Reporting a Concern:

- Act immediately to ensure the individual's safety
- Report to the DSL without delay
- Record the concern factually in the safeguarding log
- DSL will assess and, if required, refer to:
    - Local Safeguarding Adults Board (LSAB)
    - Police (if urgent risk or criminal offence)
    - CQC (if serious incident)

Whistleblowing:

Staff must report unsafe practices. The Whistleblowing Policy supports staff who raise genuine concerns.

6. Record Keeping

- All safeguarding concerns are recorded in a secure safeguarding file
- Records include date, time, concern, action taken, and outcome
- Documentation is confidential and shared only on a need-to-know basis

7. Training

- All staff complete safeguarding training as part of induction
- Refresher training is completed annually

- DSL and deputies attend advanced safeguarding training every 2 years

8. Partnership Working

[INSERT CARE HOME NAME] will co-operate fully with:

- Local authority safeguarding teams
- The Care Quality Commission (CQC)
- Health and social care professionals
- Police and legal representatives when appropriate

9. Monitoring and Review

- This policy is reviewed annually or following a safeguarding incident or regulatory update
- Lessons learned are shared with the team to improve practice

10. Related Policies and Documents

- Whistleblowing Policy
- Mental Capacity Act & DoLS Policy
- Recruitment Policy
- Complaints Policy
- Staff Code of Conduct

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